

Regression Testing

Definition (Based on Transcript + Industry Standard)

Regression Testing is performed to ensure that **new code changes (bug fixes, enhancements, new features)** have **not broken the existing functionality** of the application.

Whenever developers fix bugs or modify code, testers must verify that **all previously working modules still work correctly** and the application's behavior has not regressed.

When Regression Testing is done?

- After bug fixes
- After enhancements
- After newly added features
- After code refactoring
- After environment upgrades

Types of Regression Testing

1. Unit Regression Testing

- Testing only the modified unit/module.
- Other modules are NOT tested.
- Done by developers.

2. Partial Regression Testing

- Testing the changed module + its **impacted modules**.
- Ensures that integration points still work.

3. Full Regression Testing

- Testing the **entire application** when large changes are made.
- Usually done before a major release.

Example

If a developer fixes an issue in “Purchase Module”, regression ensures:

- Purchase module works after fix ✓
- Dependent modules like Inventory, Billing, Invoice also work ✓

★ Interview Importance

Regression testing is **one of the most frequently asked interview topics**.

? Different Ways This Question Is Asked in Interviews

- What is Regression Testing?
 - Why is Regression Testing needed?
 - When do you perform Regression Testing?
 - What is the difference between full and partial regression?
 - How do you select test cases for regression?
 - Can automation be used for regression?
 - How is regression testing different from re-testing?
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2 Re-testing (Confirmation Testing)

✓ Definition

Re-Testing is performed to **verify whether the defect fixed by the developer is actually resolved**.

It is also called **Confirmation Testing**.

📌 Key Characteristics

- Always done on **failed test cases only**
 - Always performed on the **same environment**
 - It is done **before regression testing**
 - Test cases are executed again **with the same input data**
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🔧 Example

If Login fails due to incorrect password validation:

1. Tester reports the bug
2. Developer fixes it
3. Tester performs **Re-testing** for that specific login scenario

4. Then tester performs **Regression Testing** on surrounding functionality
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★ Interview Importance

Often asked with regression testing.

? Possible Interview Questions

- What is Re-testing?
 - How is Re-testing different from Regression Testing?
 - Do you perform Re-testing with same or different data?
 - Is Re-testing mandatory for every bug?
 - Can Re-testing be automated?
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3 Difference Between Regression vs Re-testing

Feature	Re-testing	Regression Testing
Purpose	Check if specific defect is fixed	Check if existing features work after changes
Scope	Only failed test cases	Large set / full app
Data	Same data used earlier	Same or new data
Execution Priority	First	After Re-testing
Mandatory?	Yes	Based on changes
Automation	Hard to automate	Highly suitable for automation

★ Interview Importance

One of the **top 5 most commonly asked** testing questions.

? Interview Variants

- Differentiate Re-testing and Regression testing
- Examples of both

- Which comes first?
 - Can regression be done without re-testing?
 - Is regression testing mandatory?
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Smoke Testing

Definition

Smoke Testing is a **basic-level** testing performed on a new build to check whether the application is **stable enough** for further testing.

It checks **critical functionalities only**, such as:

- Login
- Navigation
- Basic UI loading
- Main workflows opening

Purpose

To ensure:

- Build is stable
- Build is testable
- No show-stopper issues exist

Performed By

- Testers (most common)
 - Developers (in Dev environment)
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Example

When QA receives a new build, they check:

- Login works
- Dashboard loads
- Pages open

If smoke fails → build is **rejected**.

★ Interview Relevance

Frequently asked in QA interviews.

? Possible Questions

- What is Smoke Testing?
 - When do you perform Smoke Testing?
 - Difference between Smoke vs Sanity testing
 - Who performs smoke testing?
 - Is smoke testing manual or automated?
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5 Sanity Testing

✓ Definition

Sanity Testing is a **narrow and deep** testing performed after receiving a build with minor fixes or small changes to ensure that:

- The fixed issue works
- Related areas are not broken

It is a **subset of Regression Testing**.

✚ Key Characteristics

- Done when time is limited
 - Focus on **specific functionalities**
 - Build acceptance after minor fixes
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★ Interview Questions

- What is Sanity Testing?
 - When do we perform Sanity Testing?
 - Why is it called a subset of regression?
 - Difference between sanity & smoke?
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Exploratory Testing

Definition

Exploratory Testing is performed **without test cases** and **without detailed documentation**, where testers explore the application to understand functionality and identify defects.

Characteristics

- Simultaneous learning, testing, and designing
- Useful when documentation is missing
- Relies on tester's domain experience
- Finds hidden defects
- Performed early in testing life cycle or in Agile

Example

You join a new project. Application is ready but no requirement document exists. You explore:

- All pages
- Features
- Links
- Validations
- Workflows

Then you document your findings → "Exploratory Notes".

Interview Variants

- What is Exploratory Testing?
 - When do you use it?
 - How is it different from Ad-hoc testing?
 - What skills are required for exploratory testing?
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7 Ad-hoc Testing

✓ Definition

Ad-hoc Testing is **informal, unstructured testing** performed without documentation, but with a specific intention:

👉 **Try to break the application by using random inputs.**

✦ Characteristics

- No documentation
 - No planning
 - Tester tries random workflows
 - Goal: find unexpected defects
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★ Interview Variants

- What is Ad-hoc testing?
 - Difference between exploratory vs ad-hoc?
 - Do we need experience for ad-hoc testing?
 - How do testers perform it?
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8 Monkey/Gorilla Testing

⚡ Monkey Testing

Random testing performed **without any knowledge** of the application.

⚡ Gorilla Testing

Testing **one module repeatedly** until it breaks.

🔧 Examples

- Monkey Testing: Clicking random buttons on a mobile app without knowing functionality.
 - Gorilla Testing: Testing only “Login” repeatedly with 200+ inputs until it crashes.
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★ Interview Variants

- What is monkey testing?
 - What is gorilla testing?
 - Difference between monkey, ad-hoc & exploratory
 - When do you perform monkey testing?
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9 Differences Between Exploratory, Ad-hoc, and Monkey Testing

Type	Knowledge of Application	Structured?	Purpose
Exploratory	Yes	Semi-structured	Learn → Test → Document
Ad-hoc	Some	Unstructured	Break the system
Monkey	None	Completely random	Stress system using random inputs

★ Interview Importance

Common question in mid-level interviews.

? Variants

- Difference among ad-hoc, monkey, exploratory
 - Give real project examples
 - When to use which technique?
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10 Positive & Negative Testing

◆ Positive Testing

Verifying the application behaves **as expected** with **valid inputs**.

◆ Negative Testing

Verifying the application behaves **correctly** with **invalid inputs**, unexpected inputs, or wrong workflows.

Example – Login Page

- Positive: Correct username + correct password → Login success
 - Negative:
 - Wrong username
 - Empty password
 - Special characters
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★ Interview Variants

- What is positive vs negative testing?
 - Why do we need negative testing?
 - Examples from your project?
 - How do you generate negative scenarios?
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End-to-End (E2E) Testing

Definition

Testing the **complete workflow** of the application from start to finish, covering all integrated systems.

Example – E-commerce

1. Login
 2. Search Product
 3. Add to Cart
 4. Checkout
 5. Payment
 6. Order Confirmation
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★ Interview Variants

- What is E2E testing?
- Difference between system testing and E2E testing?

- Example of E2E testing from your project?
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1 2 Localization Testing

✓ Definition

Testing how well the application adapts to a **specific locale**, including:

- Language
 - Currency
 - Date formats
 - Local laws
 - Number formats
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Example

English → Hindi

USD → INR

MM/DD/YYYY → DD/MM/YYYY

1 3 Internationalization / Globalization Testing

Internationalization (i18n)

Designing software so it can be easily localized.

Globalization

Ensuring the product works across multiple regions, languages, and cultures.

? Interview Variants

- What is localization testing?
- What is internationalization testing?
- i18n vs L10n
- Real examples from your project?